

200 nuclear weapons is what experts say India is capable of building

NUCLEAR ARSENAL

India is developing a range of nuke weapons and delivery systems

FISSILE STOCK

India has retained 8 reactors for military use to add to its fissile material stock for bombs.

MISSILES

Agni variants are the workhorse for the country's nuclear missile delivery systems.

NUKE SUB

India is in the process of building an indigenously designed nuclear submarine.

FIGHTERS

The Sukhois are India's main nuclear strike aircraft apart from the Mirages.



look on Kakodkar's face it was apparent that India had got what it wanted from France—nuclear fuel, reactors, reprocessing rights for spent fuel and possibly enrichment technology as well. Later he told INDIA TODAY, "It's a perfect agreement."

Meanwhile, the French nuclear power giant, Areva, has already been having meetings with the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL). The two have homed in on a site in Jaitapur in Maharashtra to set up a nuclear park that would have possibly six top-of-the-line French reactors of 1,600 MW each in the first phase. Costing close to \$2 billion each, it could add 9,600 MW of power in the next five years alone and bring into India some of the latest nuclear technology. For the French, the business would be worth close to \$12 billion. But Indian firms would benefit too. S.K. Jain, NPCIL chairman and managing director, points out that there is a huge capacity constraint across the globe for nuclear power. That would mean that companies like Areva would outsource manufacturing of equipment to Indian companies like Larsen & Toubro and Bharat Forge. Jain says India is pushing for a steady indigenisation of imported plants with the vendors and it could go up to as much as 80 per cent for future plants.

By December, when the new Russian President Dmitry Medvedev makes his maiden visit to India, the NPCIL would be signing a similar agreement with its counterpart Rosatom for the supply of four reactors of 1,000 MW each to be set up in Kudankulam in Tamil Nadu. Under an earlier agreement, the Russians are building two giant 1,000 MW reactors at a cost of Rs 14,000 crore, expected to be commissioned by 2010. An agreement with Russia will bring in fuel as well as reactor and reprocessing technology.

American companies who believe they have first right over India's imported nuclear pie are already champing at the bit. Both GE and Westinghouse, the big two of the US nuclear industry, are making major bids for nuclear reactors and could win as many as four reactors in the next couple of years. GE is promising an astonishing 40-month completion if India